About the Poet

Nadia Bush - 'The House on Elm Street' was published by Nadia Bush, a budding poetess, in April 2017. Born on Sep. 24th, she lives in Somerset, Pennsylvania. She used this poem for her English class because she was told to write a 'dark' poem. The poem describes the mysterious house and a never-growing tree. The poet fears going inside the house.

Glossary

Elm Street (n.) - one of the most common street names in the US

flicker (v) - to shine unsteadily

tempted (v) - provoked someone to do wrong

rumors (Am.E) (n) - false stories

fade (v.) - to vanish gradually

A. Read the given lines and answer the questions given below.

1. *It sat alone.*
   What happened there is still today unknown.
   It is a very mysterious place,
   And inside you can tell it has a ton of space,
   But at the same time it is bare to the bone.

   a. What does 'It' refer to?
   b. Pick out the line that indicates the size of the house

2. *I drive past the house almost every day.*
   The house seems to be a bit brighter.
   On this warm summer day in May.
   It plays with your mind.

   a. Who does 'I' refer to?
   b. Pick out the alliterated words in the 2nd line.

3. *It never grows leaves,*
   Not in the winter, spring, summer or fall.
   It just sits there never getting small or ever growing tall.

   a. What does 'it' refer to?
   b. In what way the tree is a mystery?

4. *Rumors are constantly being made,*
   And each day the house just begins to fade.
   What happened inside that house?

   a. Does the house remain the same every day?
   b. Why does the poet consider the house to be a mystery?

5. *What happened inside that house?*
   I really don't know
   I guess it will always be a mystery.

   a. Does the poet know what happened in the house?
   b. What is mysterious about the house?

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